

Across Borders: The Bridge Forward

跨越边界：通向下一程

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The fifth arc closed at a **bridge**, not at a **station**. A **formal presentation** had been drafted for the **church** hall in the **north**, and a second one for the **south**; a **cable**, a **sign**, and a **badge** on the table were all the **gear** they had. “The **medium** is the **trip**,” Aisha said, “and the **trip** is the **document**.”

The **mission** had become an **associate**: a small organization for the **protection** of passengers, with a **guest** list, a **reservation** book, and a **seat** for every complaint. “You cannot explain a **bridge** to someone who has never bent under a load,” the old **cowboy** said. His only **hobby** was the railway, and his **heel** had worn a **trace** in the **aisle** of the carriage.

What happened next was a **migration** of habits rather than of people: the **cruise** passengers learned the ferry, and the commuters learned the shuttle. “We leave nothing behind but a **log**,” Maya said. “And a **log** is a way of saying: we were here, in the night, at this window.”

The **repair** of the **cabin** took a week. A **swallow** nested under the **bay window**, a **tender** note arrived from the **associate** in the country, and a **draft** of the new timetable was pinned to the **aisle** wall. “We receive more than we create,” Lin wrote. “That is why the position matters.”

Around the **bridge**, the town had begun to **endure** its own success: a **trail** for tourists, a **rest** stop, and a **forward step** that nobody had planned. “About a year from now,” the **associate** said, “somebody will say we did it like that on purpose. We must explain what really happened.” It was, in the end, the same promise as before, moved one **bridge** further along. The **church** by the **bay** had a **god** in its window and a **finish** to its stone that no **repair** could copy; the **aisle**, the **seat**, and the **tender** farewell were all part of the same **formal** goodbye. The **mission** was finished, and the **associate** would keep the **log**. A **hobby** became a **badge**, and a **badge** became a promise. A **gender** balance in the crew, a **transit** pass for every **guest**, and a plan to **initiate** a second **trail**: these were the last three items on the **draft**. A border is not a line on the ground; it is the distance between what you meant and what arrived.

中文翻译

第五段弧线结束在一座桥上，而不是一个车站。一份正式的陈述已经为北方的教堂大厅起草，另一份为南方；桌上的一根电缆、一块牌和一枚徽章，就是他们全部的装备。“媒介就是旅程，”艾莎说，“而旅程就是文件。”

使命已经变成了一位伙伴：一个保护乘客的小组织，有一份来宾名单、一本预订簿，以及为每一条抱怨准备的一个席位。“你无法向一个从未在重压下弯过腰的人解释一座桥，”那位老牛仔说。他唯一的爱好就是铁路，而他的脚跟已在车厢的过道上磨出了一道痕迹。

接下来发生的，是习惯的迁移而不是人的迁移：邮轮乘客学会了渡轮，通勤者学会了穿梭车。“我们除了日志什么也不留下，”曼雅说，“而日志是一种说法：我们来过，在夜里，在这扇窗前。”

船舱的修理花了一周。一只燕子在凸窗下筑了巢，一封温柔的信从乡下的伙伴那里寄来，新时刻表的草稿钉在过道墙上。“我们接受的比创造的多，”林伟写道，“这就是位置为什么重要。”

桥的周围，小镇已经开始承受自己的成功：一条给游客的小径、一处休息站，以及一个没人计划过的向前一步。“大约一年之后，”那位伙伴说，“会有人说我们当初就是这样设计的。我们必须解释真正发生了什么。”说到底，这和从前是同一个承诺，只是又向前挪过了一座桥。海湾边的那座教堂，窗里有一位神，它的石头有一种任何修补都复制不来的收尾；过道、座位和那句温柔的告别，都属于同一个正式的告别。使命完成了，而那位伙伴会保存日志。一个爱好变成了徽章，而一枚徽章变成了承诺。船员中的性别平衡、给每位客人的一张通行证，以及启动第二条小径的计划：草稿上的最后三项。国界不是地上的一条线；它是你想说的和你送到的之间的距离。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
church tʃɜ:tʃ POS: n	n. 教堂, 礼拜, 教会; vt. 使人接受宗教仪式; a. 教堂的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of the groups of Christians who have their own beliefs and forms of worship; n. a place for public (esp...
god ^ɒd POS: n	n. 上帝, 神像, 偶像; vt. 使神化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the supernatural being conceived as the perfect and omnipotent and omniscient originator and ruler of the...
north nɔ:θ POS: n	n. 北方, 北; a. 北的, 北方的; adv. 向北方, 在北方 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the region of the United States lying to the north of the Mason-Dixon line; n. the cardinal compass point t...
step step POS: n	n. 步骤, 步, 步幅, 脚步声, 踏级, 步伐, 短距离, 步态, 手段, 等级; vt. 踏, 以步测量, 跨步, 使成阶梯状; vi. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of changing location by raising the foot and setting it down; n. support consisting of a place to r...
south sauθ POS: n	n. 南方, 南; a. 南的, 向南的; adv. 在南方; vi. 转向南方 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the region of the United States lying to the south of the Mason-Dixon line; n. the cardinal compass point t...
rest rest POS: n	n. 休息, 睡眠, 安息, 稍息, 静止, 支架, 休息处, 其余者, 剩余部分; vi. 休息, 睡, 长眠, 安心, 静止, 停止, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. freedom from activity (work or strain or responsibility); n. a state of inaction; n. euphemisms for death (b...
forward 'fɔ:wəd POS: a	a. 向前的, 早的, 迅速的, 在前的, 进步的; vt. 促进...的生长, 转寄, 运送; adv. 向前地; [计] 前推, 转信 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the person who plays the position of forward in certain games, such as basketball, soccer, or hockey; n. a...
station 'steɪʃən POS: n	n. 车站, 站, 局, 驻地, 位置, 身分, 地位; vt. 安置, 配置, 驻扎; [计] 站 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a facility equipped with special equipment and personnel for a particular purpose; n. (nautical) the locati...
sign sain POS: n	n. 符号, 招牌, 征兆, 正负号, 手势; vt. 签名, 打手势表达; vi. 签名; [计] 正负号; 符号; 符号字符 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a perceptible indication of something not immediately apparent (as a visible clue that something has happe...
finish 'finɪʃ POS: n	n. 完成, 结束, 末道漆, 磨光, 完美; vt. 完成, 结束, 用完, 毁掉; vi. 结束; [计] 完成 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the place designated as the end (as of a race or journey); n. designated event that concludes a contest (es...
seat si:t POS: n	n. 座, 座位, 位子, 席位, 所在地; vt. 使坐下, 使就座, 为...设座于, 使就职; vi. 安装在底座上 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a space reserved for sitting (as in a theater or on a train or airplane); n. furniture that is designed for...
medium 'mi:diəm POS: n	n. 媒体, 方法, 媒介; a. 半生熟的, 中间的; [计] 媒体, 中 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a means or instrumentality for storing or communicating information; n. the surrounding environment; n. an i...
trip trip POS: n	n. 旅行, 绊倒, 摔倒, 失足, 差错, 旅程; vt. 使跌倒, 使犯错, 使失败; vi. 轻快地走, 绊倒, 失误, 犯错, 结巴, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a journey for some purpose (usually including the return); n. a hallucinatory experience induced by drugs; n...
document 'dɒkjumənt POS: n	n. 文件, 公文, 文档; vt. 证明, 为...引证; [计] 文档 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. writing that provides information (especially information of an official nature); n. anything serving as a...
mission 'mɪʃən POS: n	n. 任务, 代表团, 使命, 传教团; vt. 派遣, 向...传教 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an organization of missionaries in a foreign land sent to carry on religious work; n. an operation that is...
associate ə'səʊʃieɪt POS: n	n. 同伴, 伙伴, 关联的事物; vt. 使联合, 使发生联系; vi. 交往; [计] 关联 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who joins with others in some activity or endeavor; n. a person with subordinate membership in a s...
protection prə'tekʃən POS: n	n. 保护, 防卫, 贸易保护制度; [计] 保护 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of protecting someone or something; n. the condition of being protected; n. the imposition of d...
guest gest POS: n	n. 客人, 来宾, 旅客; [化] 客体 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a visitor to whom hospitality is extended; n. United States journalist (born in England) noted for his synd...
bridge brɪdʒ POS: n	n. 桥, 舰桥, 桥梁, 桥牌; vt. 架桥于, 跨越; [计] 桥, 网桥, 桥接器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a structure that allows people or vehicles to cross an obstacle such as a river or canal or railway etc.; n...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
formal 'fɔ:məl POS: a	a. 正式的, 形式的, 礼仪的, 拘于礼节的, 拘谨的; n. 正式的社交活动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. being in accord with established forms and conventions and requirements (as e.g. of formal dress); s. chara...
trail treil POS: n	n. 踪迹, 痕迹, 一串, 尾部, 小径, 持枪姿势; vt. 拖, 尾随, 追踪, 落后于, 开出路; vi. 拖曳, 垂下, 落后, 飘... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a track or mark left by something that has passed; n. a path or track roughly blazed through wild or hilly...
gender 'dʒendə POS: n	n. 性; vt. 产生 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a grammatical category in inflected languages governing the agreement between nouns and pronouns and adject...
cable 'keɪbl POS: n	n. 电缆, 海底电报, 缆, 索; vi. 打海底电报; vt. 发海底电报, 缚住; [计] 电缆 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a telegram sent abroad; n. a conductor for transmitting electrical or optical signals or electric power; n. ...
bend bend POS: vi	vi. 变弯曲, 屈服; vt. 使弯曲, 使屈服; n. 弯曲 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a circular segment of a curve; n. curved segment (of a road or river or railroad track etc.); n. a town in c...
presentation ,prezən'teɪʃən POS: n	n. 赠与, 描述, 介绍; [计] 简报 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of formally presenting something (as a prize or reward); n. a show or display; the act of pres...
bay bei POS: n	n. 海湾, 狗吠声, 月桂; vt. 吠, 使走投无路; vi. 吠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an indentation of a shoreline larger than a cove but smaller than a gulf; n. the sound of a hound on the sc...
gear ɡiə POS: n	n. 齿轮, 工具; vt. 以齿轮连起, 开动, 使适应, 安排; vi. 连接上, 适合 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a toothed wheel that engages another toothed mechanism in order to change the speed or direction of transm...
draft dræft, dra:ft POS: n	n. 气流, 草稿, 汇票, 草案; vt. 起草, 征兵; [计] 草稿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a document ordering the payment of money; drawn by one person or bank on another; n. a current of air (usua...
trace treɪs POS: n	n. 痕迹, 踪迹, 微量, 迹线, 缰绳; vt. 追踪, 回溯, 描绘; vi. 追溯, 沿路走 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a just detectable amount; n. an indication that something has been present; n. either of two lines that conn...
repair ri'peə POS: n	n. 修理, 补救, 修复; vt. 修理, 修补, 补救, 恢复, 补偿; vi. 修理, 修补, 补救, 恢复, 去, 常去, 集合 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of putting something in working order again; n. a formal way of referring to the condition of somet...
reservation ,rezə'veɪʃən POS: n	n. 保留, 预定, 保留品, 保留地; [经] 预定, 预约, 权益保留 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a district that is reserved for particular purpose; n. a statement that limits or restricts some claim; n. t...
heel hi:l POS: n	n. 脚后跟, 踵, 后部, 倾侧; vt. 尾随, 装以鞋跟, 倾侧, 追赶; vi. 紧随, 用脚后跟传球 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the bottom of a shoe or boot; the back part of a shoe or boot that touches the ground and provides elevati...
cabin 'kæbɪn POS: n	n. 小屋, 客舱; vt. 关在小屋 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. small room on a ship or boat where people sleep; n. a small house built of wood; usually in a wooded area; n. ...
swallow 'swɒləʊ POS: n	n. 燕子, 吞咽, 喉; vt. 咽, 淹没, 吞没, 耗尽, 轻信, 忍受, 抑制; vi. 吞下, 咽下 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small amount of liquid food; n. the act of swallowing; n. small long-winged songbird noted for swift grace...
initiate 'ɪnɪʃieɪt POS: n	n. 入会, 开始; a. 新加入的; vt. 开始, 传授基本知识给 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who has been admitted to membership in a scholarly field; n. people who have been introduced to the...
log lɒɡ POS: n	n. 记录, 圆木, 日志, 计程仪; vt. 伐木, 切, 航行; vi. 伐木; [计] 日志 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a segment of the trunk of a tree when stripped of branches; n. a written record of messages sent or receive...
endure ɪn'dʒʊə POS: vt	vt. 忍受, 忍耐, 容忍, 耐; vi. (正式)持久, 持续; [计] 仍能工作, 继续工作 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v put up with something or somebody unpleasant; v face and withstand with courage; v continue to live through h...
tender 'tendə POS: a	a. 嫩的, 柔软的, 脆弱的, 温柔的, 亲切的, 未成熟的, 微妙的, 棘手的, 审慎的; vt. 使变嫩, 提供, 偿还; vi. 变柔... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that can be used as an official medium of payment; n. car attached to a locomotive to carry fuel...
aisle aɪl POS: n	n. 走廊, 侧廊, 过道; [机] 走道 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a long narrow passage (as in a cave or woods); n. passageway between seating areas as in an auditorium or p...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
migration maɪ'greɪʃən POS: n	n. 移民, 移往, 移动; [计] 迁移 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the movement of persons from one country or locality to another; n. a group of people migrating together (e...
cruise kru:z POS: n	n. 巡航, 巡弋, 漫游; v. 巡航, 巡弋, 漫游 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an ocean trip taken for pleasure; v. drive around aimlessly but ostentatiously and at leisure; v. travel at...
transit 'trænsɪt POS: n	n. 经过, 通行, 运输, 运输线, 转变; vt. 运送, 使通过, 经过; vi. 通过 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make a passage or journey from one place to another; v. pass across (a sign or house of the zodiac) or pass...
cowboy 'kaʊbɔɪ POS: n	n. 牛仔, 牛郎, 牧童 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a hired hand who tends cattle and performs other duties on horseback; n. a performer who gives exhibitions...
hobby 'hɒbi POS: n	n. 嗜好, 癖好, 爱好 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a child's plaything consisting of an imitation horse mounted on rockers; the child straddles it and preten...
badge bædʒ POS: n	n. 徽章, 标记; [计] 标记 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an emblem (a small piece of plastic or cloth or metal) that signifies your status (rank or membership or a...